

Grant applications for the Support Plantation Establishment program have closed.

The Australian Government is providing \$72.29 million (GST exclusive) in grant funding over four years from 2023–24 to 2026–27.

A total of 82 projects have been announced and are currently underway or complete. Project delivery will continue throughout 2025-26 and 2026-27.

The funding supports the establishment of new long-rotation softwood and hardwood plantation forests in Australia and assists the sector in responding to the projected growth in demand for domestically sourced timber resources.

The objectives of the program are to:

- increase future plantation forest resources available for processing, as well as for plantation forest management, harvesting and haulage employment
- support private industry, First Nations businesses, farm foresters and state and territory government forestry bodies to expand the Australian plantation forest estate
- contribute to meeting Australia's carbon emission reduction targets, including under the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change, and the Kyoto Protocol to the Climate Change Convention.

Grantees are required to provide a co-contribution at least equal to the grant amount and grants were open to private industry, First Nations businesses, farm foresters and state and territory government forestry bodies.

Watch

See how the program is supporting grantees to establish new plantations across Australia.

Plantation Pine Products Support Plantation Establishment Program case study

(Duration 1 mins 46 secs)

Introduction

This is the transcript of a video case study produced by the Department of Agriculture Fisheries and Forestry as part of the Support Plantation Establishment Program. It was filmed with Plantation Pine Products on-site in Oberon, NSW in 2024.

Transcript

Video begins [0:00]

Music plays

Text appears on screen:

The Support Plantation Establishment Program is a \$73.76 million Australian Government Grant Program

The funding supports the establishment of new long-rotation softwood and hardwood plantation forests across Australia

[0:11]

Text changes on screen:

Plantation Pine Products were awarded \$7.04 million in funding to support the establishment of 3,520 hectares of new plantation forests

Angus Spreckley: This plantation was planted in August this year with Pinus Radiata at 1,600 stems a hectare.

It will be 30 meter tall trees, probably about 600 stems a hectare. This will be thinned twice, down to about 600 stems a hectare during the rotation.

Areas around Oberon have 800mm of rainfall, so the cooler temperatures in summer, plenty of rainfall in winter, so it's good growing conditions for pine trees.

The high up-front costs of forestry plantations is a challenge. Reducing that up-front cost which is what the grant does makes it significantly more palatable to plant trees.

If you own the land and your only cost is establishment and you can get that just for minor costs, it reduces all of the hurdles for a farmer to plant a bad paddock into pines.

So you'll have structural grade lumber for your framing of your house, you'll have MDF, or medium density fibreboard and particleboard used for kitchen cupboards, kitchen benches.

Here with the sawmills only taking Radiata, we're pretty keen to enter partnerships with farmers. We'll establish the trees with you, we'll manage and harvest on your behalf and take the wood to market. We need lots of logs.

[1:35]

Music plays

Department of Agriculture Fisheries and Forestry logo appears on screen

Text appears on screen:

Applications are open for grant round three of the Support Plantation Establishment program.

Find out more and apply at GrantConnect.

[1:46]

Video ends

Case studies

The stories of the grantees and their projects that will deliver Australia’s future forest products.

Applications

Grant applications for the program have closed.

- Round 1 of the program ran from 21 June 2023 to 24 January 2024.
- Round 2 of the program ran from 9 February 2024 to 27 June 2024.
- Round 3 of the program ran from 11 October 2024 to 5 November 2025.

Successful applicants to date

Grant applications for Round 1 opened on 21 June 2023 and closed on 24 January 2024.

Round Funded	Funding Recipient	Project details	Funding (GST Exclusive)	Region
Round 1	Plantation Pine Products Australia Pty Ltd	Softwood 308 hectares	\$616,000.00	NSW
Round 1	Tamplin Family Trust	Hardwood 86 hectares	\$172,000.00	NSW
Round 1	Tasmanian Carbon Afforestation Sub-Trust	Hardwood 60 hectares	\$120,000.00	TAS
Round 1	Napier Family Trust	Softwood 84 hectares	\$168,000.00	TAS
Round 1	Plantation Pine Products Australia Pty Ltd	Softwood 935 hectares	\$1,870,000.00	NSW
Round 1	A.C Fisher & S.J Fisher	Softwood 66 hectares	\$132,000.00	TAS
Round 1	A Biskaps & S.J Biskaps	Hardwood	\$92,000.00	QLD

		46 hectares		
		Hardwood		
Round 1	F Hildebrand & L.M Holt	22.5 hectares	\$44,820.00	VIC
		Softwood		
Round 1	Plantation Pine Products Australia Pty Ltd	606 hectares	\$1,212,000.00	NSW
		Softwood		
Round 1	J & S Thompson	402 hectares	\$804,000.00	NSW
		Softwood		
Round 1	H.H Mackinnon & H.H Mackinnon & R.A Mackinnon	73 hectares	\$145,600.00	VIC
		Hardwood		
Round 1	Sapphire Forests Pty Ltd	27.5 hectares	\$55,000.00	NSW
		Softwood		
Round 1	Salmon Marketing Trust	401 hectares	\$802,000.00	TAS
		Softwood		
Round 1	Creese Farming (QLD) Pty Ltd	50 hectares	\$94,850.00	TAS
		Softwood		
Round 1	Morgan Sawmill Jamestown Pty Ltd	455.87 hectares	\$911,740.00	SA
		Softwood		
Round 1	Forestry Corporation of New South Wales	465 hectares	\$930,000.00	NSW
		Softwood		
Round 1	Forestry Corporation of New South Wales	660 hectares	\$1,320,000.00	NSW
		Softwood		
Round 1	Miles, Robert William	204 hectares	\$408,000.00	NSW

Grant applications for Round 2 opened on 9 February 2024 and closed on 27 June 2024.

Round Funded	Funding Recipient	Project details	Funding (GST Exclusive)	Region
Round 2	Forestry Investment Trust	Softwood 214.1 hectares	\$66,371.00	WA
Round 2	Tasmanian Carbon Afforestation Sub-Trust	Softwood 154 hectares	\$211,765.00	TAS
Round 2	G 5 Forestry Pty Ltd	Softwood 650 hectares	\$1,300,000.00	NSW
Round 2	Mitsui & Co. Wood Resources Oceania Pty. Ltd.	Softwood 260.5 hectares	\$258,698.58	WA
Round 2	SFA Nature Based Solutions Unit Trust	Softwood 89 hectares	\$178,000.00	VIC
Round 2	Plantation Pine Products Australia Pty Ltd	Softwood 1671 hectares	\$3,342,000.00	NSW, VIC
Round 2	Forestry Corporation of New South Wales	Softwood 116 hectares	\$208,800.00	NSW
Round 2	Forestry Corporation of New South Wales	Softwood 30 hectares	\$60,000.00	NSW

Grant applications for Round 3 opened on 11 October 2024 and will close on 5 November 2025.

Round Funded	Funding Recipient	Project details	Funding (GST Exclusive)	Region
Round 3	DL Colless Plantation Trust No. 3	Softwood 40 hectares	\$80,000.00	VIC
Round 3	Chelimi Pty Ltd	Hardwood 21 hectares	\$42,000.00	VIC

Round 3	H.A Bebb & E.G Hewitt & J Hewitt & A.J Stevens & V.R Stevens & The Trustee For Gr Gibson Discretionary Trust & The Trustee For The Liffey Trust & The Trustee For West Elk Trust	Softwood 188.49 hectares	\$375,275.68	TAS
Round 3	Associated Kiln Driers Pty Ltd	Softwood 54.3 hectares	\$108,600.00	NSW
Round 3	Forestry Investment Trust	Softwood 424.6 hectares	\$382,729.17	VIC
Round 3	Forestry Investment Trust	Softwood 147.2 hectares	\$192,596.00	WA
Round 3	Tasmanian Carbon Afforestation Sub-Trust	Softwood 62 hectares	\$123,752.00	TAS
Round 3	Mitsui & Co. Wood Resources Oceania Pty. Ltd.	Softwood 958 hectares	\$1,915,760.50	WA
Round 3	Morgan Sawmill Jamestown Pty Ltd	Softwood 165.97 hectares	\$331,940.00	SA
Round 3	Carbon Neutral Pty Ltd	Hardwood 259.9 hectares	\$519,749.91	WA
Round 3	Carbon Neutral Pty Ltd	Softwood 679 hectares	\$1,358,000.00	WA
Round 3	Milne Farming Pty Ltd	Hardwood 123 hectares	\$246,000.00	VIC
Round 3	Carbon Neutral Pty Ltd	Hardwood 1928 hectares	\$3,856,000.00	NSW

Round 3	Mitsui & Co. Wood Resources Oceania Pty. Ltd.	Softwood 216.1 hectares	\$432,200.00	WA
Round 3	Fairthorne Timber Trading Pty Ltd	Softwood 56.1 hectares	\$112,200.00	VIC
Round 3	Maxwell Family Trust & J.D Thompson & S.J Thompson	Softwood 670 hectares	\$1,340,000.00	NSW
Round 3	Tasmanian Carbon Afforestation Sub-Trust	Softwood 196 hectares	\$300,860.00	TAS
Round 3	Tasmanian Carbon Afforestation Sub-Trust	Hardwood 91.4 hectares	\$131,035.20	TAS
Round 3	Tiwi Plantations Pty Ltd	Hardwood 2709 hectares	\$5,418,000.00	NT
Round 3	Tiwi Plantations Pty Ltd	Hardwood 2259 hectares	\$4,518,000.00	NT
Round 3	D.J Creese and P.G Creese	Softwood 191 hectares	\$382,000.00	TAS
Round 3	Cultura Australia Pty Ltd	Softwood 1319 hectares	\$1,097,305.53	WA
Round 3	Mareeba Tas Pty Ltd	Softwood and hardwood 43.7 hectares	\$87,400.00	TAS
Round 3	Tasmanian Carbon Afforestation Sub-Trust	Softwood 85 hectares	\$136,025.00	TAS
Round 3	Tasmanian Carbon Afforestation Sub-Trust	Softwood 67 hectares	\$100,165.00	TAS

Round 3	Tasmanian Carbon Afforestation Sub-Trust	Softwood 131 hectares	\$195,845.00	TAS
Round 3	Plantation Pine Products Australia Pty Ltd	Softwood 770 hectares	\$1,540,000.00	NSW
Round 3	Salmon, Timothy	Softwood 88 hectares	\$176,000.00	NSW
Round 3	Seven Generations Forestry Pty Ltd	Hardwood 24.9 hectares	\$49,800.00	NSW
Round 3	Rantson Discretionary Trust	Softwood 337 hectares	\$674,000.00	NSW
Round 3	Forestry Investment Trust	Softwood 287.8 hectares	\$442,046.00	VIC
Round 3	ANZLAFF Sub 1	Softwood 960 hectares	\$1,920,000.00	NSW
Round 3	Forest Products Commission	Softwood 442.4 hectares	\$784,110.00	WA
Round 3	Forestry Investment Trust	Softwood 700 hectares	\$1,127,500.00	WA
Round 3	ANZLAFF Sub 1	Softwood 1300 hectares	\$2,600,000.00	NSW
Round 3	Plantation Pine Products Australia Pty Ltd	Softwood 1278 hectares	\$2,556,000.00	NSW
Round 3	Tasmanian Carbon Afforestation Sub-Trust	Softwood 65 hectares	\$125,005.00	TAS
Round 3	Australian Carbon Products Pty Ltd		\$245,200.00	TAS

		Softwood 122.6 hectares		
Round 3	Tiwi Plantations Pty Ltd	Hardwood 599 hectares	\$1,198,000.00	NT
Round 3	Midway Limited	Softwood 1541.5 hectares	\$3,083,000.00	NSW
Round 3	Mt Vernon Pastoral Pty. Ltd.	Softwood 57 hectares	\$114,000.00	TAS
Round 3	Britton Brothers Proprietary Limited	Hardwood 57.3 hectares	\$114,600.00	TAS
Round 3	SFA Nature Based Solutions Pty Ltd	Softwood 466 hectares	\$932,000.00	VIC
Round 3	Forest Products Commission	Softwood 115.8 hectares	\$231,600.00	WA
Round 3	Forest Products Commission	Softwood 60.5 hectares	\$121,000.00	WA
Round 3	Forest Products Commission	Softwood 64.6 hectares	\$129,200.00	WA
Round 3	Forest Products Commission	Softwood 57.1 hectares	\$114,195.00	WA
Round 3	Cultura Australia Pty Ltd	Softwood 1565.8 hectares	\$3,127,983.00	WA
Round 3	Tasmanian Carbon Afforestation Sub-Trust	Softwood 132 hectares	\$263,964.00	TAS
Round 3	Redgum Forestry Pty Ltd	Softwood	\$1,000,000.00	NSW

		500 hectares		
		Softwood		
Round 3	Tasmanian Carbon Afforestation Sub-Trust	46 hectares	\$91,642.00	TAS
		Hardwood		
Round 3	Milne Farming Pty Ltd	60 hectares	\$120,000.00	VIC
		Softwood		
Round 3	HQPlantations Pty Ltd	467.8 hectares	\$935,600.00	QLD
		Softwood		
Round 3	HQPlantations Pty Ltd	42.39 hectares	\$84,780.00	QLD
		Softwood		
Round 3	Hancock Victorian Plantations Pty Limited	139.2 hectares	\$278,400.00	VIC
		Softwood		
Round 3	Tasmania Natural Asset Trust	5194.7 hectares	\$8,806,511.43	TAS

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/agriculture-land/forestry/industries/support-plantation-establishment-program>